Speaking

Shakespeare describes the characteristics of the various stages of man. You are in the second stage of life. What do you think of your roles and responsibilities at this stage? Discuss with your partner and share your ideas with the class.

Listening

Listen to the poem and fill in the blanks with appropriate words and phrases. If required listen to the poem again.

The World Is Too Much with Us

The world is too much with us; late and soon,

Getting and spending, we lay waste our powers;

Little we see in _____ that is ours;

We have given _____ away, a sordid boon!

This Sea that bares her bosom _____,

_____ that will be howling at all hours,

And are up-gathered now like _____,

For this, for everything, we are _____;

It _____ us not. Great God! I'd rather be

A Pagan suckled in a creed outworn;

So might I, standing on this pleasant lea,

Have glimpses that would make me less forlorn;

Have sight of Proteus rising _____

Or hear old Triton blow his wreathed horn.

William Wordsworth

Parallel Reading

On the Life of Man

What is our life? A play of passion,

Our mirth the music of division,

Our mother's wombs the tiring-houses be,

Where we are dressed for this short comedy.

Heaven the judicious sharp spectator is,

That sits and marks still who doth act amiss.

Our graves that hide us from the setting sun

Are like drawn curtains when the play is done.

Thus march we, playing, to our latest rest,

Only we die in earnest, that's no jest

Sir Walter Raleigh

12th General_English_Unit_3_B_Poem.indd 94 07-12-2021 18:03:23